

CIRQLVERSE — Rings 14–25 Design (12 all-new exotic shores)

Twelve brand-new, hand-authored rings beyond the biome ring (0–13). These are **destinations, not templates**: each is an exotic biome we haven't built, with its own **landmark set-piece**, a **marquee mystery/choice quest** (the headline), quick **palate-cleanser** shorts, a **difficult multi-stage co-op campaign**, a **sub-realm payoff**, and a small **named cast**. Together with the 12 biome rings, this gives **24 distinct rings** to work with.

Direction locked with the owner: all-new exotic biomes · quest variety leans **Mystery + Choice** · CIRQLSPHERE is the umbrella brand over all games (wordmark pass deferred until after the game work).

Design rules for every ring here

- **A marquee quest that's a real story** — a multi-beat mystery with a **branching choice** at the end that shifts reward *and* standing (like *The Sunken Runes*, but per ring).
- **Short↔long rhythm** — each big arc is surrounded by 1–2 quick quests so it never grinds.
- **Outer-ring co-op campaigns** — difficult, Renown-gated party expeditions (we currently have *zero* off the Town).
- **Sub-realm payoffs** — every cave/hollow-tree/cloud-stair earns its keep (a vault, a boss, or a postcard vista).
- **Biome-aware naming + a named cast** so each shore is a place.
- **Build-reward ties** — several marquees drop biome-flavoured décor/materials for your CIRQLSPACE.
- **Choice never punishes hard** — the fork trades *flavour* (a cosmetic / an ally / a lore beat) against *Renown*, so both paths feel good.

The new quest shapes (mystery + choice first)

Shape	Feel	Used as
Mystery	Follow a multi-clue trail, talk to a cast, deduce	Most marquees
Choice	A fork that shifts reward + standing	Ending beat of most marquees
Restore/Build	Repair a landmark in stages → drops CIRQLSPACE décor	Some campaigns
Escort	Lead a creature/NPC past hazards	Some shorts
Timed	Beat a tide / bolt / geyser	Sprinkled shorts + a few campaigns
Boss/Trial	A sub-realm challenge	The hardest campaigns

Ring 14 — Glassmere ◆ *singing glass-dune desert*

Look: dunes of wind-fused glass that chime in the wind; prismatic pale-cyan/rose refractions; glass-reeds and crystal-cacti; wind-carved glass arches; heat-mirage shimmer (no water). **Hero fauna:** a glass-scaled sand-skink that rings faintly as it moves.

Landmark — The Prism Monolith: a giant standing glass shard at the hub that splits daylight into a rainbow fan across the dunes.

Marquee — "The Colour That Isn't" (mystery → choice): the Monolith casts six colours, but at dusk a hidden **seventh beam** appears. Track where it lands across three dunes to uncover a buried chime-shrine. **Choice:** *ring the shrine* (wakes the desert's song — a music/cosmetic reward) or *let it sleep* (Renown + a lore fragment about who tuned the dunes).

Shorts: *Tune the Reeds* (walk past 4 glass-reeds in pitch order) · *Chase the Mirage* (a quick reach).

Campaign — "Refraction" (Epic · Rank 3): a party aligns 3 movable prisms to bend the Monolith's beam onto a sealed vault — a light-puzzle solved together.

Sub-realm (cave) — the Geode Hollow: walls of singing crystal; a 360° postcard chamber.

Cast: Sable the Glasswright (keeper) · Echo, a child who can *hear* the seventh colour.

Ring 15 — Sporehaven *towering bioluminescent fungal jungle*

Look: giant glowing mushroom-**towers** you walk beneath (vertical, unlike the flat marsh); constant drifting spore-rain motes; teal/violet canopy light. **Hero fauna:** a spore-moth swarm and a slow, luminous glow-snail.

Landmark — The Motherbloom: a colossal pulsing fungal spire at the hub, breathing light.

Marquee — "The Rot & the Bloom" (mystery → choice): the Motherbloom is dimming. Investigate three lesser blooms; one is infected. **Choice:** *burn the infected bloom* (fast cure, but a grove is lost) or *nurse it* (a longer multi-visit cure that saves the grove — more Renown).

Shorts: *Follow the Spores* (a gather that drifts on the wind) · *Cap the Sprouts* (quick interact).

Campaign — "Deep Bloom" (Epic · Rank 4): descend the hollow-tree sub-realm to relight the mycelium network node-by-node, past a fungal-guardian gate.

Sub-realm (hollow tree) — the Mycelium Deep: an underground-glow chamber threaded with light-veins.

Cast: Fenwick the Mycologist · Mold, a grumpy spore-tender.

Ring 16 — Mirrormere Flats *white salt mirror-lake*

Look: an endless white salt flat under a mirror-thin water sheen that doubles the whole sky; shimmering mirages; bone-white + sky-mirror palette. **Hero fauna:** a long-legged mirror-heron that appears to walk on its own reflection.

Landmark — The Doubled Gate: an arch whose reflection is a *different* arch.

Marquee — "Which Sky Is Real" (the signature choice quest): a traveller's reflection has gone missing. Follow the places where reflection and reality quietly disagree to unmask a **mirage-thief**. **Choice:** *give them your reflection* (they become real — you lose a cosmetic slot for a day) or *bind them* (they stay a ghost — Renown + their story).

Shorts: *Step Only on Solid Sky* (a light reach-puzzle across mirror tiles).

Campaign — "The Long Mirror" (Epic · Rank 3): the party crosses the flats by staying inside each other's reflections — co-op positioning.

Sub-realm (cloud stair) — the Sky-Overlook: where the mirror-sea meets the real one (postcard).

Cast: Vesper, a keeper with no reflection · the Mirage.

Ring 17 — Stormstep ⚡ *perpetual-lightning steppe*

Look: a dark grass steppe under constant sheet-lightning; **fulgurite** glass spires where bolts struck; static motes; bruise-violet + electric-white palette. **Hero fauna:** a static-charged jackrabbit that sparks when it hops.

Landmark — The Iron Tree: a lightning-scarred metal-bark tree that rings like a bell when struck.

Marquee — "Where Lightning Remembers" (mystery → choice): the strikes aren't random — they spell a path. Map three strike-sites to find a buried **sky-anchor**. **Choice:** *raise the anchor* (calms the storm, opens a hidden grove) or *leave it* (an endless-storm cosmetic + Renown).

Shorts: *Beat the Bolt* (a timed dash between strikes).

Campaign — "Grounded" (Epic · Rank 4): a party plants 3 lightning rods to safely reach the Iron Tree — a defend-style coordination run.

Sub-realm (cave) — the Fulgurite Cavern: a lattice of glass tubes fused by ancient bolts.

Cast: Bram the Stormwarden · Flint, a fearless rod-runner.

Ring 18 — The Leviathan Coast *giant fossil-bone shore*

Look: a beach of colossal fossil ribs arching over the sand, ancient leviathan skulls, tidepools inside the eye-sockets; bleached-bone + deep-sea-teal glow; a distant whale-song ambience. **Hero fauna:** scuttling bone-crabs.

Landmark — The Ribcage Cathedral: you walk *inside* a leviathan's ribs at the hub.

Marquee — "The Last Song of the Deep" (mystery → choice): reassemble a leviathan's death-song from four bone-flutes scattered along the shore, then play it at the cathedral. **Choice:** *lay the spirit to rest* (Renown + a calm falls over the coast) or *record its song* (a new music theme / cosmetic — ties into the soundtrack).

Shorts: *Tidepool Census* (a quick gather in the eye-socket pools).

Campaign — "Leviathan Rising" (Epic · Rank 5 · boss): the party wakes a guardian bone-serpent in the cave sub-realm and must out-position it.

Sub-realm (cave) — the Marrow-Deep: glowing with abyssal light.

Cast: Ossa the Bonesinger · a hermit called Barnacle.

Ring 19 — The Floating Isles (Skardrift) ☁ *chunks of land afloat over a cloud-sea*

Look: broken islets hovering over a cloud-sea, linked by **updraft columns** you ride between them; petals and leaves drift *upward*; dawn-gold + sky-blue. **Hero fauna:** a gliding sky-manta drifting between isles.

Landmark — The Anchor Stone: the one isle still chained to the world — a windmill-shrine.

Marquee — "What Holds the Sky" (mystery → choice): the isles are drifting apart. Read the wind-patterns to find which of three anchor-chains is fraying. **Choice:** *re-anchor it* (stabilises the ring, opens a far isle) or *cut it free* (a drifting-isle sanctuary + Renown).

Shorts: *Catch the Updraft* (a short vertical traversal).

Campaign — "Isle-Hop" (Epic · Rank 4 · timed): a party relay across five isles via timed updrafts.

Sub-realm (cloud stair) — the Thunderhead Vista: above the isles, the world spread below (postcard).

Cast: Zephyr the Windwright · Wisp, a kite-maker.

Ring 20 — Amberhold *resin forest where life is frozen in glowing amber*

Look: a forest where creatures and old light are trapped in **glowing amber resin**; warm internal gold light; slow amber-drips; honey-gold + deep-brown palette. **Hero fauna:** a recently-freed amber-moth, still shedding resin-dust.

Landmark — The Heartwood Amber: a house-sized amber block with *something moving inside*.

Marquee — "What Sleeps in Amber" (mystery → choice, big): four amber pods hold four sleepers; the tablet warns only one should wake. Read each sleeper's dream (branching dialog) to judge who's benign, then **choose who to wake at the Heartwood** — one becomes a rare ally NPC, one is a trick that costs sparqs; the clues tell them apart.

Shorts: *Free the Light* (tap 3 small amber-glimmers loose).

Campaign — "The Long Thaw" (Epic · Rank 5 · restore): melt the resin channels with lantern-heat in the right sequence to free a trapped grove.

Sub-realm (hollow tree) — the Amber Vault: a chamber of frozen fireflies.

Cast: Rue the Amberkeep · a sleeper known only as The Guest.

Ring 21 — The Verdigris *a fallen CIRQL ring-city reclaimed by luminous moss*

Look: an ancient collapsed ring-city overgrown with glowing verdigris moss and vines; broken columns, a sunken plaza, a dead fountain; copper-green + rose-bloom palette. **Hero fauna:** moss-deer picking through the ruins (a woodland callback, recoloured).

Landmark — The Broken Rotunda: a half-domed civic hall with a silent fountain.

Marquee — "Who Lived Here" (mystery, lore-heavy → choice): restore three mural fragments and read the city's fall — the truth reframes the world's history. **Choice:** *restore the fountain* (the city partly reawakens — seeds future sub-shops) or *leave it a memorial* (Renown + a solemn cosmetic).

Shorts: *Rubbing of the Glyph* (a quick interact set across broken tablets).

Campaign — "Reclamation" (Epic · Rank 6 · restore): a party clears four rubble-gates to reopen the old ring-road.

Sub-realm (cave) — the Undercroft Archive: glowing shelves of lost knowledge.

Cast: Cartogra, an old keeper who *remembers* · Coin, a scavenger.

Ring 22 — Tanglemere Mangrove *a half-submerged glowing mangrove maze*

Look: a maze of luminous mangrove roots over black water, broken boardwalk fragments, drifting lanterns; teal-black water + firefly-gold light. **Hero fauna:** a glow-otter that will lead you through the maze.

Landmark — The Lantern Tree: a mangrove hung with a hundred drifting lights at the hub.

Marquee — "The False Light" (mystery → choice): someone is moving the guide-lanterns to lead travellers astray. Track the pattern and catch the culprit — a lonely marsh-sprite. **Choice:** *report them* (Renown) or *teach them to guide instead* (they become a helpful sub-realm guide NPC).

Shorts: *Follow the Otter* (an escort short — keep up as it leads you out).

Campaign — "The Deepwater Run" (Epic · Rank 4 · timed): the party threads the root-maze together, each carrying a light, before the tide rises.

Sub-realm (hollow tree) — the Root-Cathedral: a vaulted chamber beneath the water.

Cast: Marsh the Lamplighter · Ember-of-the-Fen, the sprite.

Ring 23 — Frostfire Rift ❄️ *a rift where glacier meets lava*

Look: a jagged rift where glaciers pour into lava channels; steam geysers, obsidian-and-ice spires, purple-white steam glow; a palette split down the middle — ice-blue / ember-orange. **Hero fauna:** a "cinder-fox" (a fox/salamander hybrid recolour) at home in the steam.

Landmark — The Seam: where a wall of ice meets a wall of fire and neither wins.

Marquee — "The Balance Keeps" (mystery → choice): the Seam is tipping toward fire. Investigate three vents to find which broke.

Choice: *cool it* (ice wins — a frozen grove + ice-décor drop) or *let it burn* (a lava grove + ember-décor drop) — each opens a different reward path.

Shorts: *Mind the Geyser* (a timed hop across erupting vents).

Campaign — "Walk the Seam" (Epic · Rank 6 · trial): the party crosses the rift alternating ice/fire safe-tiles in sync — a hard co-op positioning trial.

Sub-realm (cave) — the Steam Grotto: mineral colour blooming in the mist.

Cast: Solstice, who tends the balance · the twins Ash & Frost.

Ring 24 — The Gilded Waste (Sunken Palace) 🏰 *gold dunes over a half-buried palace*

Look: rolling gold-dust dunes half-swallowing a vast buried palace; gilded spires poking through the sand; sunset palette + gold glow.

Hero fauna: a jewelled desert-fox (a gilded fennec recolour).

Landmark — The Throne in the Sand: a half-buried golden throne room.

Marquee — "The King Under the Dune" (mystery → choice, major): uncover the fate of the buried court through four relics, each a small mystery. At the throne, **choose:** *claim the crown* (a power/cosmetic reward — but the sand keeps rising) or *seal the palace* (Renown + a guardian's blessing).

Shorts: *Dig for Glimmers* (a gather in the shifting dunes).

Campaign — "The Excavation" (Epic · Rank 7 · restore + boss): a multi-stage party dig — clear the sand from three gates, then descend to the vault guardian.

Sub-realm (cave) — the Treasure Vault: a heist-puzzle payoff behind the throne.

Cast: Nyx the Duneseer · Marigold, a would-be heir.

Ring 25 — Nightglass Caverns (The Hollow Reach) *a walkable blacklight-cavern ring — the finale*

Look: perpetual twilight under a cavern-dark sky, everything lit by **crystal veins and glow-fungus** — the true blacklight-cave feel that started the whole glow-up, but as an open, walkable shore; near-black palette shot through with neon crystal. **Hero fauna:** a blind crystal-moth that navigates by *your* light.

Landmark — The Heartcrystal: a cathedral-sized crystal at the hub that pulses with the world's own light.

Marquee — "The Last Light" (mystery → choice, finale): the Heartcrystal is fading. Gather three lost light-shards, each guarded by a small mystery elsewhere on the ring, and rekindle it. **Final choice (an ending beat):** *share the light outward* (the whole ring blooms into a spectacular payoff) or *keep it contained* (a private sanctuary + top-tier Renown).

Shorts: *Light the Way* (kindle scattered glow-fungus clusters).

Campaign — "Into the Reach" (Epic · Rank 7 · the toughest): a full-party expedition through the caverns to the Heartcrystal, with a light-management mechanic and a final guardian.

Sub-realm (cave) — the Deep Vein: the brightest, most beautiful chamber in the world — the ultimate postcard.

Cast: Lumen the Lightkeeper, the world's oldest keeper · Spark, an echo.

Rollout notes (for when we build)

- **These layer on the generator** — each ring still gets its procedural side quests for coverage; the marquee + campaign + landmark are the authored layer on top.
- **Order of build:** biome art kit → landmark set-piece → marquee quest (new mystery/choice quest engine) → campaign → sub-realm payoff → cast/dialog.
- **New engine work needed first:** a **branching mystery/choice quest type** (clue objectives + a fork that writes a flag + grants one of two rewards) — reusable across all 12. This is the one real system to add before authoring.
- **Naming fix:** adopt biome-aware naming for these (and retro-fit rings 2–13) so names match their shore.
- **CIRQLSPHERE:** once the game work lands, restyle CIRQLBACK / CIRQLSPACE / CIRQLSPHERE / CIRQLVERSE wordmarks — **CIRQL** large, second word small in purple `#7c3aed`.